

A
PAPER

PRACTICE PAPER A · 1 HOUR · 50 MARKS

GCSE SPANISH READING

AQA · Higher Tier

A full reading paper in the shape of the real one, with the mark scheme at the back.

PONCHO
SPANISH

NAME

DATE

AQA · GCSE SPANISH 8692

GCSE SPANISH

Paper 3 · Reading

HIGHER TIER · PRACTICE PAPER A · 8692/RH

TIME ALLOWED	MAXIMUM MARK	PAPER REFERENCE
1 HOUR	50	8692/RH

MATERIALS

- You will need no other materials.
- You must not use a dictionary.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer all questions.
- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided.
- In Section A, answer the questions in English. In Section B, translate the sentences into English.

INFORMATION

- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- There is a mark scheme at the back. Do not look at it until you have finished.

ADVICE

- Read each question carefully before you answer it.
- Never leave a box or a line empty: a sensible guess costs nothing.

Antes de empezar

This is a Poncho practice paper. It follows the shape, the timings and the mark allocation of AQA GCSE Spanish 8692, Paper 3 · Reading, but every text and every question in it is written by Poncho Spanish. It is not a past paper and it is not published by the exam board.

Sit it in one go, with a clock and without a dictionary. Mark it afterwards with the scheme at the back, and write down every word you did not know — that list is the most useful page in the whole paper.

Always check the current specification on your exam board's website: boards do update their documents.

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SECTION A READING COMPREHENSION

40 MARKS

1 NEWSPAPER HEADLINES

You read some headlines in a Spanish newspaper.

A Los institutos de la región prohíben los envases de un solo uso en las cafeterías.
B El ayuntamiento abrirá una residencia para mayores antes de marzo.
C Récord de público en la final de balonmano femenino.
D Los agricultores venderán sus productos los domingos en la plaza.
E Una antigua fábrica se convertirá en un centro cultural para jóvenes.

Which headline matches each description? Write the correct letter in each box.

0 1 News about a local market. ☐ [1 mark]

0 2 News about a sports competition. ☐ [1 mark]

0 3 An environmental decision. ☐ [1 mark]

[3 marks]

2 TECHNOLOGY

You see an online forum. Some Spanish students are writing about the technology they use.

ARIADNA
Antes pasaba horas con la consola, pero ya casi no la enciendo porque este año tengo exámenes. La Red está llena de datos útiles, aunque conviene comprobar de dónde salen.

BRUNO
Llevo años programando y todavía me divierte. Desde que el gimnasio cerró, sigo clases de yoga en línea en el salón de casa.

CECILIA
Casi todos mis deberes los hago en la tableta. Hay páginas con exámenes antiguos que me vienen genial. Para hablar con mi familia uso el móvil, que llevo siempre encima.

Write A for Ariadna, B for Bruno or C for Cecilia. Write the correct letter in each box.

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04 Who exercises at home? ☐ [1 mark]

05 Who warns that information online should be checked? ☐ [1 mark]

06 Who always carries a device with them? ☐ [1 mark]

07 Who has been doing the same activity for years? ☐ [1 mark]

08 Who uses the internet to prepare for exams? ☐ [1 mark]

[5 marks]

3 HOLIDAYS

You see this brochure about Extremadura, a region in the west of Spain.

Merece la pena recorrer Monfragüe*. Hay rutas señalizadas y, con unos prismáticos, se ven águilas casi todo el día.

Aunque en julio el calor puede ser agobiante, las piscinas naturales de los ríos están frías incluso en pleno verano. Hay que llegar temprano porque se llenan.

El 23 de abril, en Cáceres*, hay mercado medieval desde las diez y conciertos gratuitos hasta la medianoche.

La comida es contundente. El jamón de la zona es conocido en todo el mundo y no es nada barato; las migas, en cambio, cuestan muy poco.

** Monfragüe, Cáceres – a national park and a city in Extremadura.*

Complete these sentences. Write the letter for the correct option in each box.

09 In Monfragüe you need binoculars to... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** follow the paths.
- **B** see the eagles.
- **C** find the entrance.

10 The natural pools... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** are warm in summer.
- **B** are empty in July.
- **C** fill up quickly.

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11 On 23 April in Cáceres the concerts... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** cost nothing.
- **B** start at midnight.
- **C** are in the market.

12 In Extremadura... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** the ham is cheap.
- **B** the migas are cheap.
- **C** the food is light.

[4 marks]

4 SLEEP AND STUDY

You read this article about how to study well.

Dormir lo suficiente no sólo te quita el cansancio: ayuda a fijar en la memoria todo lo que estudiaste durante el día.

Si ya te cuesta concentrarte, lo peor que puedes hacer es estudiar con música con letra: el cerebro intenta seguir las palabras y pierde el hilo.

Beber poca agua provoca dolores de cabeza al cabo de un par de horas, y entonces ya no hay repaso que valga.

Para que el sueño sea de calidad conviene acostarse siempre a la misma hora.

En cuanto a los aparatos electrónicos, hay dos consejos: déjalos fuera del dormitorio y apágalos una hora antes de dormir.

Si nada de esto funciona, prueba a estudiar caminando: el senderismo* corto antes de repasar despeja la cabeza.

Answer the following questions in English.

13 What does sleeping enough help you do, apart from feeling less tired? **[1 mark]**

14 What should you avoid if you already find it hard to concentrate? **[1 mark]**

15 What happens if you do not drink enough water? **[1 mark]**

16 What should you do to improve the quality of your sleep? **[1 mark]**

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17 What two pieces of advice are given about electronic devices? **[2 marks]**

.....

Read the last sentence again. What is senderismo?

18 ☐ **[1 mark]**

- **A** A kind of music.
- **B** A kind of food.
- **C** An outdoor activity.

[7 marks]

5 NEREA SOLER

You read this extract from a magazine article about Nerea Soler, a Spanish singer.

Nerea Soler es una cantante muy conocida. Nació en un pueblo de Galicia y hoy vive en Madrid. Pasó tres años en México, donde descubrió instrumentos nuevos.

Nerea tiene millones de seguidores, pero este año ha decidido publicar menos fotos de su familia. Algunos periodistas la critican porque casi nunca da entrevistas.

En su último concierto llevaba un collar* enorme que le regaló su abuela.

** collar – necklace*

Using the information from the text, complete the sentences in English. Write one word in each space.

Example: Nerea is a well-known singer.

19 Nerea was born in a village in ..... . **[1 mark]**

20 In Mexico Nerea ..... new instruments. **[1 mark]**

21 This year, Nerea has published ..... photos of her family. **[1 mark]**

22 Journalists criticise Nerea because she hardly ever gives ..... . **[1 mark]**

Read the last sentence again. What is a collar?

23 ☐ **[1 mark]**

- **A** Something you eat.
- **B** Something you wear.
- **C** Something you read.

[5 marks]

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6 LEAVING HOME

You read an article about young people in Spain and the age at which they leave home.

A Los alquileres de las ciudades grandes suben más rápido que los sueldos de los recién titulados.

B Cada vez más estudiantes eligen la facultad que tienen a veinte minutos de casa.

C Vivir con los padres hasta los treinta ya no se considera un fracaso.

D Tres de cada cuatro jóvenes dicen que ven a sus abuelos al menos una vez por semana.

E Las empresas ofrecen contratos de tres meses que no permiten planificar nada.

Which statement matches each idea? Write the correct letter in each box.

24 Closer contact with grandparents. ☐ [1 mark]

25 Difficulties for young people finding stable work. ☐ [1 mark]

26 A change in what society expects. ☐ [1 mark]

27 Studying at the nearest university. ☐ [1 mark]

[4 marks]

7 WHERE WOULD YOU LIVE?

Two Spanish teenagers say where they would like to live and why.

JIMENA

Si pudiera elegir, me iría a vivir a una isla pequeña. No soporto el ruido de la ciudad y allí se duerme con la ventana abierta.

ÓSCAR

Yo me mudaría a Buenos Aires sin pensarlo. Hay teatros, librerías y conciertos cada noche, y aquí en mi pueblo no pasa nada.

Answer the following questions in English.

28 Jimena: place [1 mark]

29 Jimena: reason [1 mark]

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30 Óscar: place [1 mark]

31 Óscar: reason [1 mark]

[4 marks]

8 MARÍA'S WEEKEND

María writes to you about her weekend.

El fin de semana pasado tuve que quedarme en casa: mi madre estaba de viaje y alguien tenía que cuidar a mi hermano pequeño.

El sábado me levanté a las once, algo rarísimo en mí, porque la noche anterior terminé un trabajo de historia a las dos de la mañana.

El domingo era la excursión del instituto a la sierra y, aunque llevaba meses esperándola, al final la anularon por la tormenta.

No me quejo: hacía semanas que no leía un libro entero y por fin lo conseguí.

Complete these sentences. Write the letter for the correct option in each box.

32 Last weekend, María... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** went away with her mother.
- **B** stayed at home.
- **C** looked after a neighbour.

33 On Saturday María got up... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** earlier than usual.
- **B** at her usual time.
- **C** later than usual.

34 The school trip... ☐ [1 mark]

- **A** was cancelled.
- **B** was moved to Saturday.
- **C** went ahead in the rain.

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35 María says that... [1 mark]

A she had a terrible weekend.

B she finally finished a book.

C she never reads.

[4 marks]

9 FREE TIME

Your Spanish friends write to you about what they like to do.

ROSA

Desde que me regalaron la cámara no paro de hacer fotos de pájaros. Los jueves, además, canto en un coro con mi vecina.

GONZALO

Los fines de semana subo a la montaña con mi grupo de senderismo. Si llueve me quedo en casa pintando acuarelas.

What two activities does each person mention? Write the correct letters in the boxes.

A Hiking in the mountains.
B Painting.
C Playing an instrument.
D Singing in a choir.
E Taking photographs.
F Watching birds on television.

36 Rosa [2 marks]

37 Gonzalo [2 marks]

[4 marks]

TOTAL FOR SECTION A = 40 MARKS

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SECTION B TRANSLATION INTO ENGLISH 10 MARKS

10 TRANSLATION

Translate these sentences into English.

38 **Cuando era pequeño vivía en el campo.** [2 marks]

39 **Mi hermana acaba de encontrar trabajo en una tienda.** [2 marks]

40 **Anoche fuimos al cumpleaños de mi prima y lo pasamos genial.** [2 marks]

41 **Si tuviera más tiempo, aprendería a tocar el piano.** [2 marks]

42 **Me preocupa que los jóvenes lean cada vez menos.** [2 marks]

[10 marks]

TOTAL FOR SECTION B = 10 MARKS

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RESPUESTAS · MARK SCHEME

ANSWERS

Mark it honestly, one mark per correct answer unless the scheme says otherwise. Where an answer could be worded in more than one way, the scheme shows the idea the examiner is looking for.

ANSWERS · SECTION A

1 NEWSPAPER HEADLINES

01 D

02 C

03 A

2 TECHNOLOGY

04 B

05 A

06 C

07 B

08 C

3 HOLIDAYS

09 B — see the eagles.

10 C — fill up quickly.

11 A — cost nothing.

12 B — the migas are cheap.

4 SLEEP AND STUDY

13 It helps fix in your memory what you studied during the day

14 Studying with music that has lyrics / words

15 You get headaches after a couple of hours

16 Always go to bed at the same time

17 Leave them out of the bedroom; switch them off an hour before sleeping

18 C — An outdoor activity.

5 NEREA SOLER

19 Galicia

20 discovered

21 fewer

22 interviews

23 B — Something you wear.

6 LEAVING HOME

24 D

25 E

26 C

27 B

7 WHERE WOULD YOU LIVE?

28 A small island

29 She cannot stand the noise of the city / you can sleep with the window open

30 Buenos Aires

31 There are theatres, bookshops and concerts every night / nothing happens in his village

8 MARÍA'S WEEKEND

32 B — stayed at home.

33 C — later than usual.

34 A — was cancelled.

35 B — she finally finished a book.

9 FREE TIME

36 D, E

37 A, B

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ANSWERS · SECTION B

10 TRANSLATION

38 When I was little / young I used to live in the countryside.

39 My sister has just found a job in a shop.

40 Last night we went to my cousin's birthday and we had a great time.

41 If I had more time, I would learn to play the piano.

42 It worries me that young people read less and less.

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¡MUCHA SUERTE!

YOU'VE GOT THIS

Finished? Mark it, count the words you did not know and come back to this paper in a fortnight. The second time around is where the marks are.

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